

NAS (GRADE 9) MOCK TEST - SOCIAL STUDIES

Impact of Change on Human Societies

Application-level mock (40 MCQs) - modelled on the NAS 2024 Grade 9 pattern.

Competency (special focus - IMPACT ON HUMAN SOCIETIES): Changes in human habitation, family structures and relationships, the nature of work, and people's socio-cultural beliefs and concepts over time (e.g. Ahimsa, and the fallout of major wars or invasions) that significantly impacted human societies.

General Instructions

1. This mock has 40 multiple-choice questions (MCQs).
2. Four question types are used, 10 questions each.
3. Each question has four options - A, B, C and D. Only ONE is correct.
4. The Answer Key with explanations is given at the end.
5. There is no negative marking in NAS.

About the references (read before verifying):

References use NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I' chapters (Ch.2-11) and the provided NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper (Q3 p.3 metallurgy; Q6 p.4 Chipko; Q15 p.9 unity in diversity; Q17 p.9 hand-made items). NOTE: the early-society TEXTBOOK pages were not provided, so NCERT items are cited at chapter level; page numbers are given only for the NAS model paper. Please verify chapter references in your Class 6-9 NCERT/SCERT edition.

SECTION 1 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS CORRECT

Apply the idea and choose the **CORRECT** statement.

1. When people shifted from nomadic hunting-gathering to settled farming, which impact on their habitation is **CORRECT**?
 - A. They began building permanent homes and villages.
 - B. They stopped living in any fixed place.
 - C. They started moving around even more than before.
 - D. They immediately built large modern factories.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'.

2. As farming began to produce surplus grain, which social impact is **CORRECT**?
 - A. Everyone stayed exactly equal, with no differences.
 - B. Differences grew - some people became more powerful or wealthy (e.g. rajas, richer families).
 - C. All people became rulers at once.
 - D. Trade and exchange stopped completely.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities' & Ch.6 'Kingdoms, Kings and an Early Republic'.

3. In the earliest cities, which statement about the nature of work is **CORRECT**?
 - A. Everyone did exactly the same work.
 - B. Work became specialised - farmers, crafts-persons, traders, priests and rulers.
 - C. No one had to work at all.
 - D. Only hunting was practised.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 & Ch.9 'Vital Villages, Thriving Towns'.

4. Which statement about the impact of Ahimsa (as taught by Mahavira and the Buddha) on society is CORRECT?
- A. It encouraged more animal sacrifices.
 - B. It spread the idea of non-violence and respect for all living beings.
 - C. It promoted wars between kingdoms.
 - D. It was mainly a method of making metal tools.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.7 'New Questions and Ideas'.

5. Which statement about the impact of the Kalinga war on Ashoka's rule is CORRECT?
- A. It made him fight even more wars.
 - B. It led him to give up war and rule through dhamma (welfare and non-violence).
 - C. It had no effect on him at all.
 - D. It made him abolish kingship.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka, the Emperor Who Gave Up War'.

6. Which statement about how megalithic burials reflect a society's beliefs is CORRECT?
- A. They show people had no beliefs about death.
 - B. They show beliefs about death, and that some were buried with more goods than others.
 - C. They were mainly used to store grain.
 - D. They were the homes of living people.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 'What Bones and Burials Tell Us'.

7. Which statement about family and work in early farming societies is CORRECT?
- A. Work was often shared within families, with different tasks for men, women and children.
 - B. Only one person in the whole village ever worked.
 - C. Children alone ruled every family.
 - D. No one reared any animals.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4.

8. Which statement about the impact of traders and pilgrims on early societies is CORRECT?
- A. It cut societies off from one another.
 - B. It spread goods, ideas and beliefs between distant regions (cultural exchange).
 - C. It ended all crafts.
 - D. It stopped the use of coins.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.10 'Traders, Kings and Pilgrims'.

9. Women in different parts of India wear saris, but the style, colour and fabric differ from region to region. Which statement about this cultural feature is CORRECT?
- A. It shows cultural imposition.
 - B. It shows unity in diversity.
 - C. It shows cultural lag.
 - D. It shows the absence of any culture.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q15 (p.9).

10. Which statement about the impact of the change from stone to metal (metallurgy) on society is CORRECT?
- A. It reduced trade and crafts.
 - B. It improved tools and ornaments and increased trade and commerce.
 - C. It made people give up farming.
 - D. It reduced cultural exchange.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q3 (p.3); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4.

SECTION 2 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS INCORRECT

Apply the idea and choose the INCORRECT statement.

11. Which statement about the impact of settling down (nomadic -> settled life) is INCORRECT?
- A. People built permanent houses.
 - B. People could store surplus food.
 - C. Villages and later towns grew up.
 - D. People stopped forming any communities.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3.

12. Which statement about social change in the earliest cities is INCORRECT?
- A. Some people became rulers and wealthy.
 - B. Crafts-persons and traders appeared.
 - C. Everyone in society remained completely equal in wealth and power.
 - D. Society became more complex.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 & Ch.6.

13. Which statement about the impact of Buddhism and Jainism (Ahimsa) is INCORRECT?
- A. They spread ideas of non-violence.
 - B. They questioned costly sacrifices and rituals.
 - C. They taught that violence and war were the best path.
 - D. They attracted many followers.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.7.

14. Which statement about the fallout of the Kalinga war is INCORRECT?
- A. There was great loss of life and suffering.
 - B. Ashoka felt deep remorse.
 - C. Ashoka turned to dhamma and the welfare of the people.
 - D. Ashoka became more eager for conquest.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8.

15. Which statement about the nature of work over time is INCORRECT?
- A. Hunting and gathering was the earliest kind of work.
 - B. Farming and herding came with settled life.
 - C. Crafts, trade and specialised jobs grew with cities.
 - D. The nature of work never changed over thousands of years.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4 & Ch.9.

16. Which statement about the impact of invasions / contact with outsiders is INCORRECT?

- A. Newcomers sometimes brought new ideas, goods or technologies.
- B. Contact could lead to cultural exchange.
- C. Invasions never affected local societies in any way.
- D. Some invasions caused destruction and a change of rulers.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.10 & Ch.11 'New Empires and Kingdoms'.

17. Which statement about family and relationships in early societies is INCORRECT?

- A. People lived in groups / kin-based communities.
- B. Work and tasks were often divided within families.
- C. Every individual lived completely alone, with no family ties.
- D. Settled life allowed larger, more stable families.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 & Ch.3.

18. Which statement about megaliths and burials is INCORRECT?

- A. They tell us about beliefs regarding death.
- B. Grave goods were placed with the dead.
- C. Differences in grave goods can show social differences.
- D. They prove that everyone was always buried in exactly the same way.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5.

19. Which statement about hand-made items and cultural heritage is INCORRECT?

- A. Hand-made items can give people a sense of connection to their cultural heritage.
- B. People are sometimes ready to pay more for hand-made items.
- C. Machine-made items can be made faster and more cheaply.
- D. Hand-made craft traditions have no cultural value at all.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q17 (p.9).

20. Which statement about the Chipko movement is INCORRECT?

- A. Logging disrupted local people's cultures and ways of earning a living.
- B. Local people protested to protect their forests and livelihoods.
- C. The movement began in the 1970s.
- D. Local people protested because they wanted to move to the cities.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q6 (p.4).

SECTION 3 - PARAGRAPH / CONTEXT / DATA-BASED

Read the passage or data and answer the question that follows.

21. Long ago people wandered in search of food. Later, when they began to grow crops, they built huts, stored grain and stayed in one place, forming villages.

The MAIN impact described here is:

- A. People became more nomadic than before.
- B. A change from a wandering life to a settled village life.
- C. The end of all farming.
- D. The building of cities on distant lands overnight.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3.

- 22.** In a Harappan city some people lived in large houses with many rooms, while others lived in small huts; some were buried with many ornaments, others with few.

This difference best shows that the early city society had:

- A.** No differences at all.
- B.** Social and economic differences (rich and poor).
- C.** Only rulers and no other people.
- D.** No houses of any kind.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 & Ch.5.

- 23.** After the Kalinga war, in which about a lakh people were killed and more taken captive, the emperor gave up war and spread messages of kindness, respect for life and welfare.

The fallout of this war on the empire's policy was a shift towards:

- A.** More conquests.
- B.** Non-violence and welfare (dhamma).
- C.** Ending the empire immediately.
- D.** Banning farming.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8.

- 24.** Mahavira and the Buddha taught that one should not harm any living being, and they questioned costly sacrifices. Many people, including traders and farmers, became their followers.

The social impact of these teachings was:

- A.** An increase in animal sacrifices.
- B.** The spread of Ahimsa and simpler beliefs across society.
- C.** The end of all religion.
- D.** More wars between kingdoms.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.7.

- 25.** As cities grew, some people became potters, weavers, metal-workers, traders and priests, while others ruled; not everyone farmed anymore.

This passage shows the impact of city life on:

- A.** The nature of work (specialisation of jobs).
- B.** The weather of the region.
- C.** The number of rivers.
- D.** The colour of the soil.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 & Ch.9.

- 26.** Traders and pilgrims travelled long distances, carrying goods and also new ideas and beliefs from one region to another.

The impact of such travel on societies was mainly:

- A.** Complete isolation of societies.
- B.** Cultural exchange and the spread of ideas.
- C.** The end of all trade.

D. The loss of all beliefs.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.10.

- 27.** In an old settlement, the earliest layers show only stone tools and simple huts; later layers show copper tools, bigger houses and ornaments.

This change over time best shows:

- A.** Society becoming simpler and poorer.
- B.** Society becoming more developed, with new technology and differences in wealth.
- C.** No change at all across time.
- D.** People giving up farming.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4.

- 28.** Women in different regions of India wear saris of different styles, colours and fabrics, yet all are Indian.

This reflects the socio-cultural feature of:

- A.** Cultural imposition.
- B.** Unity in diversity.
- C.** Cultural lag.
- D.** Complete isolation.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q15 (p.9).

- 29.** The forest-dwelling people of a region depended on the forest for food, culture and their way of earning a living. When the government allowed large-scale logging, they protested.

The main reason for their protest was that logging:

- A.** Was happening too slowly.
- B.** Disrupted their culture and ways of earning a living.
- C.** Gave them a share of the profits.
- D.** Helped them move to the cities.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q6 (p.4).

- 30.** People began burying their dead under large stones (megaliths), sometimes placing pots, tools and beads with the body.

This practice tells us mainly about the society's:

- A.** Farming methods.
- B.** Beliefs about death and the afterlife.
- C.** Trade routes.
- D.** City drainage system.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5.

SECTION 4 - ASSERTION - REASONING

Each item has an Assertion (A) and a Reason (R). Choose the correct option.

- 31.** Assertion (A): The beginning of farming led people to build permanent homes and villages.
Reason (R): Growing crops meant people had to stay in one place to tend and harvest them.

A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
B. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
C. A is true but R is false
D. A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3.

- 32.** Assertion (A): Society in the earliest cities became more unequal.
Reason (R): With surplus food and specialised work, some people became rulers and wealthy while others did not.

A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
B. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
C. A is true but R is false
D. A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4 & Ch.6.

- 33.** Assertion (A): The Kalinga war had a deep impact on Ashoka.
Reason (R): The suffering it caused led him to give up war and follow dhamma and non-violence.

A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
B. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
C. A is true but R is false
D. A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.8.

- 34.** Assertion (A): The teachings of Ahimsa changed people's socio-cultural beliefs.
Reason (R): Mahavira and the Buddha invented iron tools.

A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
B. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
C. A is true but R is false
D. A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.7.

- 35.** Assertion (A): Trade and travel spread ideas and beliefs between distant regions.
Reason (R): Traders and pilgrims carried goods and ideas as they moved.

A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
B. Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
C. A is true but R is false
D. A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.10.

- 36.** Assertion (A): Megalithic burials tell us about a society's beliefs about death.
Reason (R): The dead were buried with grave goods such as pots, tools and beads.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5.

- 37.** Assertion (A): The nature of work changed as human societies developed.
Reason (R): Over time, hunting-gathering gave way to farming, and then to crafts, trade and specialised jobs.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4 & Ch.9.

- 38.** Assertion (A): Contact with outsiders and invasions could change local societies.
Reason (R): They sometimes brought new goods, ideas, technologies or new rulers.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.10 & Ch.11.

- 39.** Assertion (A): The different regional styles of the sari show India's unity in diversity.
Reason (R): India is the largest democracy in the world.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q15 (p.9).

- 40.** Assertion (A): Settling down changed family life, allowing larger and more stable families.
Reason (R): People kept moving from place to place every single day and never settled.
- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
 - C.** A is true but R is false
 - D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3.

ANSWER KEY WITH EXPLANATIONS

SECTION 1 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS CORRECT

1. (A) Farming tied people to their fields, so they built permanent homes and formed villages.
2. (B) Surplus and control over it led to social differences - some became rulers/wealthy, others did not.
3. (B) City life brought specialised occupations instead of everyone doing the same work.
4. (B) Ahimsa spread non-violence and respect for life, changing people's beliefs and practices.
5. (B) The suffering of Kalinga turned Ashoka away from war towards dhamma and people's welfare.
6. (B) Burials with grave goods reflect beliefs about death - and differences in goods hint at social differences.
7. (A) In early farming/herding families, tasks were divided among members - a change in family roles and work.
8. (B) Movement of traders and pilgrims carried goods and ideas, leading to cultural exchange.
9. (B) Different regional styles within one shared tradition illustrate unity in diversity.
10. (B) Metal tools/ornaments were better and were exchanged, boosting crafts, trade and commerce.

SECTION 2 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS INCORRECT

11. (D) Settling down actually led to LARGER communities (villages/towns), not the end of communities.
12. (C) City society became UNEQUAL and complex - not everyone remained equal.
13. (C) Both stressed non-violence; they did NOT teach that violence/war was best.
14. (D) After Kalinga, Ashoka gave up conquest; he did not become more eager for it.
15. (D) The nature of work changed greatly over time - it did not stay the same.
16. (C) Invasions and contact DID affect societies - through exchange, destruction or new rulers.
17. (C) Early people lived in kin groups and families - not completely alone.
18. (D) Burials differed (in goods and effort), which itself points to social differences - not sameness.
19. (D) Hand-made crafts carry strong cultural value - that is why people value and pay more for them.
20. (D) They protested to SAVE their forests and way of life, not to move to cities.

SECTION 3 - PARAGRAPH / CONTEXT / DATA-BASED

21. (B) The passage shows the shift from wandering (nomadic) life to settled village life.
22. (B) Different houses and burials point to social and economic inequality in city society.
23. (B) The war's suffering pushed the empire's policy towards dhamma - non-violence and welfare.
24. (B) Their teachings spread non-violence and simpler beliefs widely across society.
25. (A) City growth changed the nature of work, creating many specialised occupations.
26. (B) Long-distance travel spread goods and ideas, leading to cultural exchange.
27. (B) New tools, bigger houses and ornaments over time show growing development and wealth differences.
28. (B) One shared tradition expressed in many regional forms is unity in diversity.
29. (B) Logging threatened their livelihood and culture, which is why they protested (Chipko).
30. (B) Burial customs and grave goods tell us about beliefs regarding death and the afterlife.

SECTION 4 - ASSERTION - REASONING

31. (A) Both true, and staying to tend crops is exactly why permanent homes/villages arose.
32. (A) Both true, and surplus + specialisation is the reason inequality grew.
33. (A) Both true, and the suffering is exactly why Ashoka changed.
34. (C) A is true, but R is false - they taught non-violence; they did not invent iron tools.

- 35. (A)** Both true, and the movement of traders/pilgrims is how ideas spread.
- 36. (A)** Both true, and grave goods reveal what people believed about death/afterlife.
- 37. (A)** Both true, and the described progression is exactly how work changed.
- 38. (A)** Both true, and the new goods/ideas/rulers are how societies were changed.
- 39. (B)** Both statements are true, but R does not explain A.
- 40. (C)** A is true, but R is false - settling meant people stopped constant moving.